

games – single player, multi-player, massively multiplayer online, real-time RPGs which include MUDs and MUSHes.

- ▶ **Sports games:** These are games whose mechanics are based on the rules of the sport on which game is being made. Many famous games such as *NFL* and *EA Cricket* come under this genre.
- ▶ **Adventure games:** These are games which test the puzzle-solving skills of the player unlike action games which tests the physical challenge. Puzzle platformers such as *Braid* and *Limbo* fall into this category.
- ▶ **Vehicle simulations:** Majority of vehicle simulation games are racing games such as *NFS*. Some of them are vehicle-stunt games.
- ▶ **Online Social Games:** Online social game genre has viral game mechanics where a player wants to play, share, and interact with his friends over a social network while playing your game. These have repetitive addictive game-play and use various new concepts such as virtual goods etc.

Choosing a gameplay mode

Propose a proper game-play mode to the player. This has to include the camera model, interaction model and general types of challenges the players will experience in that mode.

The perspective, interaction model, and gameplay is what defines a particular gameplay mode will look like.

Perspective is a means of perceiving the game world and depends upon camera angles. This may include top-down view, side –scrolling view etc in 2D or 3D. Interaction modal includes the way player interacts with world. This may include first person like in first person shooter where the player cannot see his avatar, third person where a player can see the avatar he is controlling or simple puzzles such as *Sudoku* where there is no avatar. Gameplay includes how the player plays the game; it may be a Cooperative, defensive, competitive, stealth mode, attack mode etc.

Thus when you decide the perspective, interaction model and gameplay, you can define the game-play mode of your game. A game can have more than one gameplay mode during its course of play.

Defining target audience

Once the designer is done with the aesthetic experience the designer wants the players to experience, the game-play mode and genre; he/she has to think about who would enjoy that experience. For every game, a target audience has to be decided. This is more of a player-centric design where you test